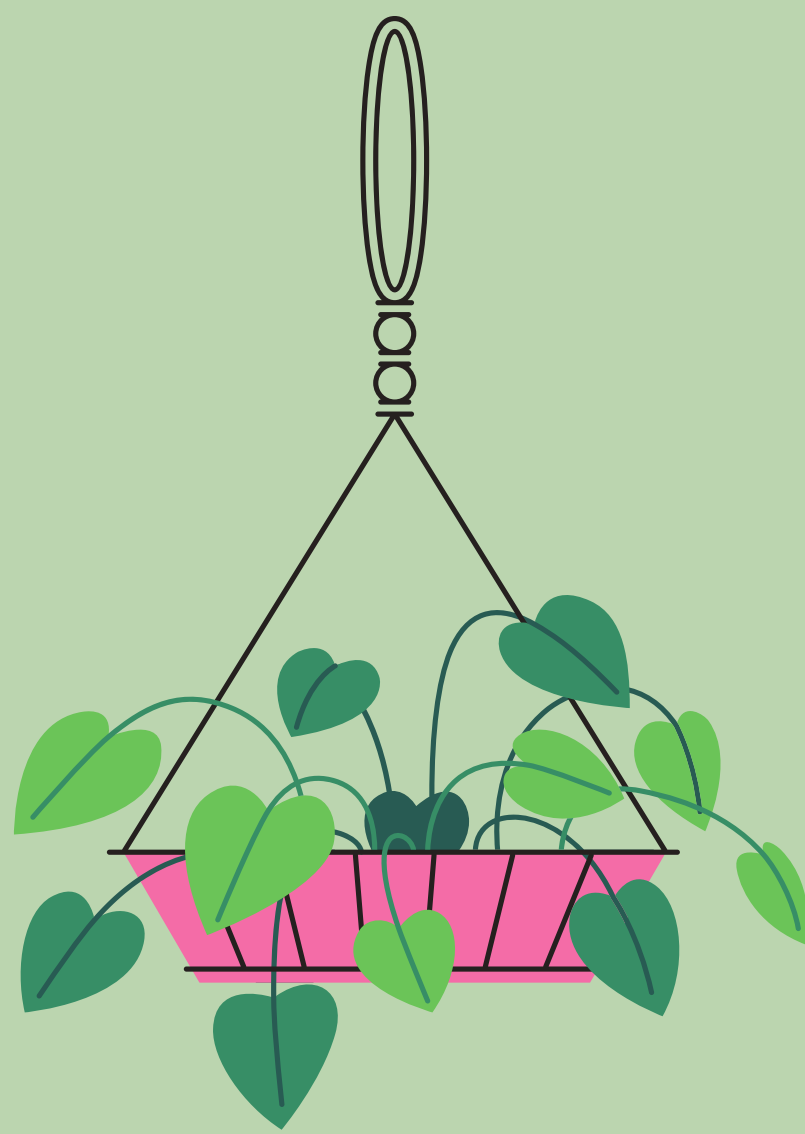
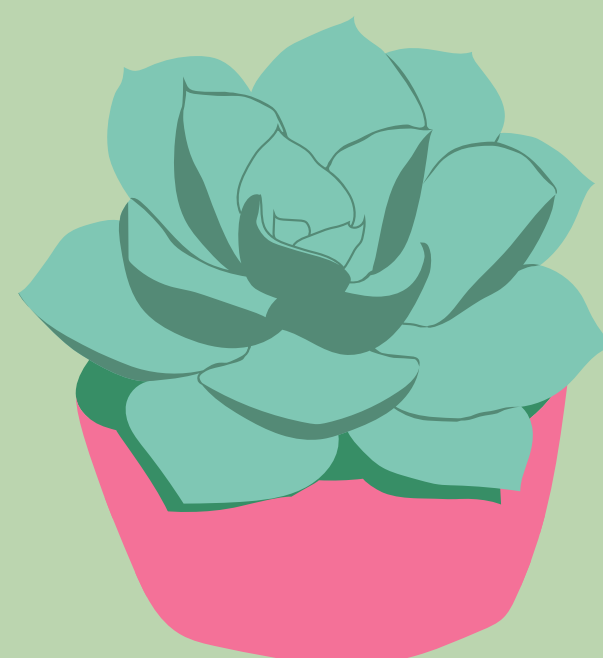




Happy House Plants



A guide to caring for indoor plants





Chapter 1: Introduction

This is a short starter handbook, not an encyclopedia. Use the care cards when you bring a plant home. Use the pest pictures as a first look only.

What's inside:

- 1. Introduction**
- 2. Getting started, plus care cards**
- 3. Light**
- 4. Water**
- 5. Soil and nutrients**
- 6. Pests and disease**
- 7. Mistakes that actually kill plants**
- 8. Cuttings, air layering, a jar of water**
- 9. More care cards**
- 10. Resources**

Keep it beside the watering can.



Golden pothos (*Epipremnum aureum*)

**The easiest vine on the starter row. Trails or climbs.
Forgives missed weeks. Does not forgive wet feet.**

Light: low to bright indirect. Keep off hot glass at noon.

Water: when the top 2–3 cm of mix is dry. Yellow leaves usually mean too wet.

Mix: houseplant mix plus perlite. The pot must have a hole. Empty the saucer after 15 minutes.

Feed: half-strength liquid in spring and summer. Skip winter.

Pets: toxic if chewed.

Common fail: misting the leaves and thinking you watered. Cut below a node to make more plants.





Snake plant (*Dracaena trifasciata*)

Upright, slow, and hard to kill if you leave it alone.

Light: low to bright. Faster in bright indirect.

Water: only when the mix is dry most of the way down.

In winter that can be a month.

Mix: cactus mix, or houseplant mix with extra grit.

Drainage hole. Skip gravel in the bottom. It does not help.

Feed: once in spring, once in midsummer, weakly.

Pets: toxic (saponins).

Common fail: a weekly watering schedule.

